

Build a Personal Safety Application in App Inventor 2



Astound your friends by building your own Android personal safety app! This tutorial in our on-going series on App Inventor 2 guides the reader in building such an app. Reading previous articles would be a great help to those just joining us in this quest to build Android apps.

Personal safety is of prime concern to each one of us. Many a time we are in difficult and dangerous situations and need a helping hand to extricate us from harm's way. As the proverb says, "Prevention is better than cure." So it is better to be prepared with a solution before a potentially harmful situation arises.

In this article, we are attempting to build a personal safety application, which in times of trouble can help us. Our goal here is to inform the ones who care for us about where we are and the activities we are involved in. We will be building a mobile application using which, on pressing a single button, we can send critical information about ourselves to the people we intend to send it to.

This tutorial series requires some basic as well as a little advanced knowledge about building Android applications with App Inventor. So let's use the knowledge acquired from the past articles in this series, to build this app.

The purpose of the application

As explained earlier, the purpose of this application revolves around the need to extricate the mobile device user from a dangerous situation. We hope to build an Android mobile application which will send the location of the user, along with some predefined text, to certain people/agencies and place a call to them to describe the situation. We will enable users to set the contact numbers of the people they wish to contact in case of emergencies. You are already aware of all the components that will be used for this application like the texting component, the phone call component, location sensor, buttons, labels, Tiny DB, etc.

GUI requirements

Every application requires a graphical user interface or GUI, which helps the user to interact with the on-screen components. How each component responds to user actions is defined in the blocks editor section. As per our current requirements, we hope to have a single button which will trigger all the events, and a